

CRANE AND BANKSMAN SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Control communication failure, blind-lift and load-movement hazards.

8-10 MINUTES

OBJECTIVE

Ensure safe communication between the crane operator, banksman and lifting team, and prevent collision, crushing and dropped-load hazards caused by blind lifts, conflicting signals, swing-radius exposure and communication failure.

TOPIC EXPLANATION

- Only the designated and competent banksman should direct the operator. Conflicting instructions from several people can lead to uncontrolled load movement.
- The banksman must maintain safe visibility of the operator and load. Blind lifts require reliable radio communication, and the lift must stop immediately if communication is lost.
- Anyone may give the emergency-stop signal. Normal operating directions, however, must come only from the appointed banksman using agreed standard signals.

REALISTIC SITE SCENARIO

- During a blind lift, both the banksman and a nearby supervisor gave the operator different instructions.
- The operator became uncertain and the load swung toward the crane's operating area.
- The event could have been prevented through the one-signalsman rule, an agreed radio channel and immediate stop on communication loss.

REMEMBER

If the operator cannot see the banksman or communication is lost, the lift must stop. Do not move when in doubt.

CRANE AND BANKSMAN SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Hazards, communication rules and daily pre-work verification.

8-10 MINUTES

KEY HAZARDS

- Multiple people directing the operator.
- Non-standard or misunderstood hand signals.
- Communication failure during blind lifting.
- Banksman moving out of the operator's or load's view.
- Personnel inside the crane swing radius.
- Workers below the suspended load or in the line of fire.
- Radio failure, interference or incorrect channel use.
- Uncontrolled load movement caused by wind.

CONTROL MEASURES

- Appoint one competent banksman.
- Confirm standard signals before starting.
- Use reliable radio communication for blind lifts.
- Stop the lift immediately if communication is lost.
- Position the banksman with clear visibility.
- Barricade the crane swing radius.
- Keep personnel clear of suspended loads.
- Explain the emergency-stop signal to the team.
- Monitor wind and visibility conditions.
- Inform the operator and team if the banksman changes.

SUPERVISOR TALKING SCRIPT

Team, only the appointed banksman will direct the operator today. We will verify hand signals and radio channels before starting. If the operator loses sight of the banksman or communication fails, the lift will stop immediately. The swing radius and suspended-load area will remain clear. Anyone may give the emergency-stop signal.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- Who is the appointed banksman today?
- Have the hand signals been confirmed?
- Which radio channel and backup method will be used?
- Where will the banksman stand during the blind lift?
- Is the crane swing radius fully barricaded?
- What will the operator do if communication is lost?

VERIFY BEFORE STARTING TODAY

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Banksman competent | ☐ Single signalman appointed |
| ☐ Signals confirmed | ☐ Radio working |
| ☐ Backup communication ready | ☐ Swing area barricaded |
| ☐ Load path clear | ☐ Visibility suitable |
| ☐ Wind acceptable | ☐ Team briefed |

ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

CRANE AND BANKSMAN SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Project / Site

Date

Presented by

Work area

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			
13			
14			

Supervisor notes / additional site instructions